

The Prompt Framework

Four lines that turn any AI into a specialist

The one-page cheat sheet from The Artificial Advantage. Keep it next to
your keyboard.

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Why most prompts fall flat

The most common mistake I see is treating AI like a search engine. You type "write me a marketing email," get something generic, and decide the tool is overhyped. The tool is rarely the problem. It is the instruction the tool was given.

Every strong prompt I write follows the same four-line shape. Give the AI a **Role**, some **Context**, a **Constraint**, and the **Outcome** you want. That is it. Learn these four lines and you can write a sharp prompt for almost anything, from memory, in under a minute.

The four lines

1. Role

Tell it who to be. A model with a job title reasons differently from a blank assistant.

You are a direct-response copywriter with ten years in email.

2. Context

Give it the facts it cannot guess: who this is for, what you are selling, where it will appear, what came before.

The reader is a mid-career professional who feels behind on AI. The product is a \$37 productivity system. This is the first email they get after signing up.

3. Constraint

Box it in. Length, format, tone, what to avoid. Constraints are where generic output goes to die.

Keep it under 90 words. Lead with a pain point. One call to action. No hype words.

4. Outcome

Say what a good result looks like and how you will use it. Ask for the format you actually want.

Give me three subject lines and one body. Plain text I can paste straight into my sender.

Copy this template

You are [role with a specific skill]. **Here is the situation:** [who it is for, what it is about, any facts that matter]. **Constraints:** [length, format, tone, what to avoid]. **Give me** [the exact output and format you want].

Fill every bracket with real details from your work. The more specific the input, the less generic the output. That trade never fails.

Before and after

Weak: "Write a LinkedIn post about our new feature."

Strong: "You are a B2B content lead who sounds like a real person having a coffee chat. We shipped one-click CSV export for our analytics tool. The reader is a data analyst who is tired of manual exports. Keep it under 120 words, one concrete example, no buzzwords. Give me the post plus three opening lines to test."

Same feature. One of these gets used, the other gets deleted. The difference is the four lines.

Three power moves

- **Ask it to ask you.** End with "Ask me anything you need before you start." It will surface the gaps you forgot to fill.
- **Show it one example.** Paste one piece you like and say "match this voice." One example beats three paragraphs of description.
- **Iterate out loud.** "Tighten the second line. Cut the adjectives. Make the ending land harder." You are directing, so direct.

This week

Pick three tasks you repeat every week. Write one framework prompt for each, save them, and reuse them. That small library is the start of your own artificial advantage.

Want the full system, plus 150 prompts already written by job function? That is the book.

The Artificial Advantage, out now on Amazon.